



PARTICIPANT GUIDE INTERNATIONAL VOLUNTEER FORUM



19-20 JUNE 2026

**BALKHASH CITY,
KARAGANDA REGION,
REPUBLIC OF KAZAKHSTAN**

DEAR PARTICIPANTS!

The Organizing Committee of the International Volunteer Forum is pleased to welcome you to the city of Balkhash. To ensure that your stay is as comfortable and safe as possible, we kindly ask you to familiarize yourself with the following information.

ABOUT THE REPUBLIC OF KAZAKHSTAN



CAPITAL CITY – ASTANA.



POPULATION – OVER 20 MILLION PEOPLE.



OFFICIAL LANGUAGE – KAZAKH.



RUSSIAN IS WIDELY USED IN EVERYDAY
COMMUNICATION.



NATIONAL CURRENCY – KAZAKHSTANI TENGE (KZT).



BALKHASH TIME ZONE – UTC+5.

ABOUT THE CITY OF BALKHASH

Balkhash is located on the shores of Lake Balkhash and is one of Kazakhstan's most renowned tourist destinations. Lake Balkhash is among **the largest lakes in the world** and is known for its unique natural environment, picturesque beaches, and favorable recreational conditions.

The uniqueness of Lake Balkhash lies in the fact that it is both **a freshwater and a saltwater lake**. The western part contains fresh water, while the eastern part contains saline water. Due to the lake's geographical and hydrological characteristics, these waters hardly mix. This rare natural phenomenon makes Balkhash one of the most remarkable aquatic ecosystems in the world.



WHAT WILL BE PROVIDED BY THE ORGANIZERS

During the Forum, participants will be provided with:

- ✓ Hotel accommodation in comfortable air-conditioned rooms;
- ✓ Bottled still drinking water in hotel rooms;
- ✓ Local SIM card with mobile communication and internet access;
- ✓ Three meals per day (breakfast, lunch, and dinner);
- ✓ Transportation and transfers according to the official Forum program;
- ✓ Assistance from volunteers of the Organizing Committee.

Each Forum participant will also receive:

- Branded T-shirt;
- Branded cap;
- Participant badge;
- Set of branded souvenirs.

We kindly encourage participants to wear the provided merchandise during official Forum activities to emphasize the unity of the international volunteer community and contribute to a shared event atmosphere.



ACCOMMODATION AND CATERING

Accommodation has been arranged for all participants throughout the Forum.

All rooms are equipped with air conditioning to ensure comfort during the summer season.

Upon arrival, bottled still drinking water will be available in every room.

Please note that bottled water is recommended for drinking purposes. Consumption of tap water is not advised.



ACCOMMODATION AND CATERING

Three meals per day will be provided for all participants.

All meals will be prepared in accordance with Halal standards.

If any participants are:

- Vegetarians;
- Vegans;
- Individuals with food allergies;
- Participants with medical or religious dietary restrictions, **we kindly ask** that this information be communicated to the Organizing Committee in advance so that individual dietary requirements can be accommodated.



CLIMATE CONDITIONS IN BALKHASH

During the Forum, hot, dry, and sunny weather is expected in Balkhash.

Average temperatures:

- **Daytime: +30°C to +35°C;**
- **Nighttime: +17°C to +20°C;**
- **Lake water temperature: +22°C to +24°C.**

Solar activity in June is very high; therefore, participants are advised to use sun protection and stay properly hydrated.

Strong steppe winds are also characteristic of the region. Weather conditions along the lakeshore may change quickly, so we recommend bringing a light jacket or windbreaker.



RECOMMENDED ITEMS TO BRING

Documents and Communication

- Passport or other identification document;
- Mobile phone and chargers;
- Power bank (if required).

Sun Protection

- Sunscreen (SPF 30+ or SPF 50+);
- Sunglasses;
- Hat, cap, or other head covering.

Personal Items

- Required medications;
- Personal first-aid kit;
- Insect repellent;
- Reusable water bottle (optional).

Clothing and Footwear

- Lightweight clothing made from natural fabrics;
- Comfortable walking shoes;
- Light sweater or windbreaker for the evening;
- Swimwear;
- Beach towel;
- Water shoes (if available).

ELECTRICITY AND CHARGING

- Voltage: 220V;
- Frequency: 50Hz;
- European-style plugs and sockets: Types C and F.

Participants are advised to bring a universal adapter if necessary.

SAFETY

AT LAKE BALKHASH

When visiting the lakeshore, please observe the following recommendations:



Swim only
in designated areas;



Follow instructions provided
by organizers and
rescue services;



Avoid prolonged
exposure to direct
sunlight;



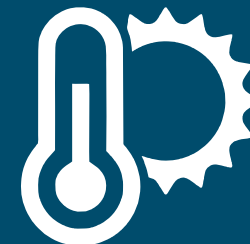
Drink water regularly;



Use sunscreen.

Some sections of the shoreline and lakebed may be rocky. Please exercise caution when entering the water.

IMPORTANT INFORMATION ABOUT HOT WEATHER



Temperatures inside closed vehicles, tents, and poorly ventilated spaces exposed to direct sunlight may significantly exceed the outside air temperature.

It is not recommended to leave the following items in such conditions:

- Drinking water;
- Medications;
- Batteries and electronic devices;
- Aerosols;
- Cosmetic products.

We strongly recommend carrying sunscreen with you whenever spending time outdoors.

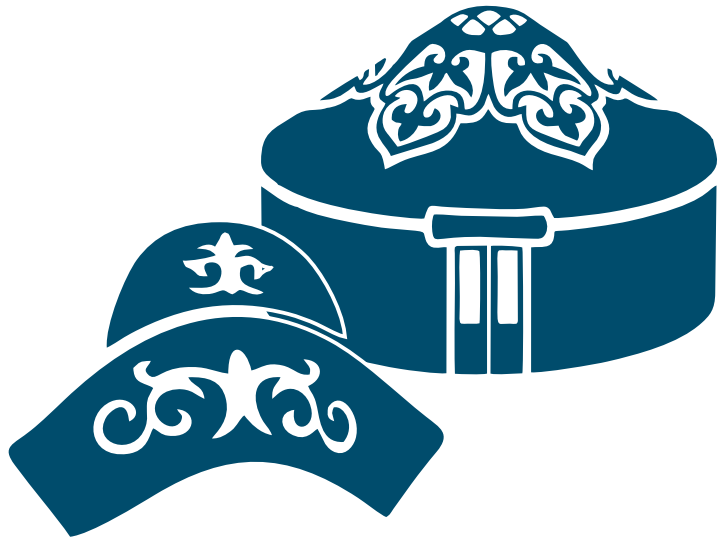


CULTURE AND TRADITIONS

Kazakhstan is a multicultural country where respect, hospitality, and kindness toward guests are highly valued.

During your stay, we would greatly appreciate it if you:

- Respect local traditions and culture;
- Show interest in the history and unique features of the region;
- Contribute to an atmosphere of friendship and mutual respect.



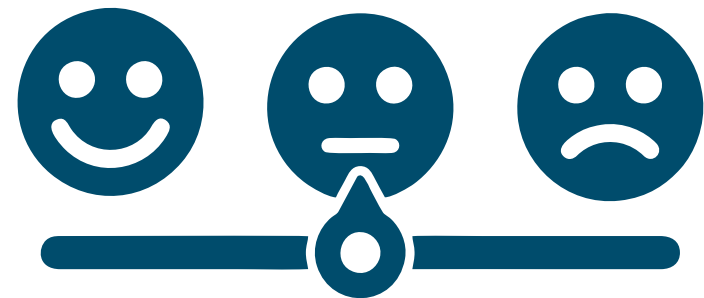
SHARE YOUR EXPERIENCE

We would be delighted if you shared your Forum experience on social media.

Post photos and videos, tell others about new friendships, engaging discussions, and the beauty of Lake Balkhash.

When publishing content, please tag the Forum's official accounts and use the official event hashtags.

Your posts will help promote volunteerism, strengthen international cooperation, and preserve the brightest memories of the Forum.



OFFICIAL FORUM ACCOUNT:



instagram:

@saryarqa_jastary

ОФИЦИАЛЬНЫЕ ХЕШТЕГИ:

#IVFBalkhash2026

#BalkhashTourFest2026

#SaryarqaJastary

EMERGENCY SERVICES

Unified Emergency Number – 112

Ambulance Service – 103

Police – 102

Fire Service – 101





ORGANIZING COMMITTEE CONTACTS

Forum Coordinator:

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Resource Center

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DEAR FRIENDS!

We are delighted to welcome you to the International Volunteer Forum in Balkhash. Your participation makes this Forum a truly international platform for exchanging experience, strengthening friendship among nations, and advancing the volunteer movement.

May these days bring you new ideas, valuable connections, and inspiration for future initiatives and projects.

Welcome to Kazakhstan, and welcome to Balkhash!

Sincerely,
**Organizing Committee of the International Volunteer
Forum Department of Youth Policy
of the Karaganda Region**